

# Research Integrity Basics

Level 1 - Research Foundations | Student Learning Pack

## How to use this pack

Read the teaching sections first, complete the worked example, do the short practice task, then take the basic knowledge check in RSRE. External references are optional further learning; you should be able to answer the core assessment from the Academy material.

## Lesson 1: What research integrity means

Research integrity means doing research honestly, transparently and responsibly. It includes accurate recording, appropriate authorship, respect for participants, careful data handling, honest reporting and disclosure of important conflicts.

Fabrication means making up data. Falsification means manipulating research materials or results dishonestly. Plagiarism means presenting another person's work or ideas without appropriate attribution. These are serious because they damage the research record and can harm people.

## Lesson 2: Integrity starts before publication

Good integrity begins when the question is planned. Keep decisions documented. Do not remove inconvenient observations simply because they do not support a preferred story. Do not change the primary outcome after seeing results without transparently explaining the change. Protect participant confidentiality and follow approved procedures.

## Lesson 3: Worked scenario

A student notices that several questionnaire responses are incomplete. The supervisor suggests deleting all incomplete responses without recording how many were removed. What should the student do? The correct approach is to document the issue, follow the analysis plan where possible, discuss appropriate handling with the research team, and report important exclusions transparently.

## Lesson 4: Authorship and contribution

Authorship should reflect meaningful scholarly contribution according to the relevant journal or institutional standards. People who helped with administration or general supervision may deserve acknowledgment rather than automatic authorship. Teams should discuss roles early and document contributions.

## Lesson 5: Check your understanding

Integrity is not simply “do not cheat.” It is a system of honest decisions that allows others to trust the research record.

## Competency check

After completing this module, you should be able to explain the core idea in your own words, identify a correct and incorrect application, and make a basic research decision using the concept.

RSRE note: The Academy is optional. Experienced researchers may use the diagnostic/competency pathway and enter other RSRE pillars directly.